



On innovation 論創新

What about the ability to innovate in China?

In fairness, innovation efforts in China in recent years have been breath taking with the growth in innovation labs and the encouragement by the Central Government for business enterprise to search for innovative solutions. It is clearly a cornerstone of the economy for business growth and development. What might help and accelerate this key functioning is the constant coaching of this process with profound understanding of the necessary culture in order to support innovation within any organization.

For example, in Israel you see that companies are constantly coming up with novel products. It's a 24-hour, 360-degree challenge and opportunity for the growing economy. And whether it is about developing security systems in Israel or games in Taiwan or new technologies

in the San Francisco Bay Area, we must be reminded that the choice is crystal clear: innovate or die.

Simply stated, the challenge for China is its ability to innovate in this next decade as it is becoming more predictable as more and more Chinese Brands become household names.

The thinking in Israel is entirely different. Their starting point is, "We are surrounded. We've got to innovate to survive." Clearly it's about courage, risk and taking initiative. You only have to look at how many Israeli companies are now listed on the NASDAQ exchange. But it all starts with leadership, the way management and decision-making takes place and the time it takes to get things done coupled with the additional time to market. The Israeli culture supports innovation, competitiveness and internal collaboration. Perhaps there is a lesson here for all of us to learn from?